THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 2

Chapter 4: **The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Which was a long-term consequence of Plassey? 1

(a) Dutch rule
(b) French control
(c) Mughal revival
(d) Company moved from trade to political control

2. In a famine, free kitchens and tax waivers would show 1

(a) relief policy **(b)** neglect **(c)** exploitation **(d)** profit

3. The statement 'Railways were laid with Indian money but served British aims' suggests 1

(a) benefit to farmers **(b)** exploitation
(c) no effect **(d)** free gift

4. Rani Abbakka's use of fireballs shows 1

(a) creative defence against a stronger fleet
(b) fear
(c) use of cannon only
(d) trade

5. What is the best evidence that India was a rich economy before colonisation? 1

(a) Its imports **(b)** Its poverty
(c) Its famines **(d)** Its large share of world GDP

6. If a government exports grain during famine, it indicates 1

(a) equal sharing **(b)** care
(c) priority of profit over relief **(d)** planning

7. Which would be primary evidence on 1857? 1

(a) A modern textbook **(b)** A letter written by a sepoy in 1857
(c) A film **(d)** A poem written in 2000

8. The role of Bahadur Shah Zafar in 1857 was mainly 1

(a) priest **(b)** British ally
(c) symbolic leader of the rebels **(d)** planter

9. **Assertion (A):** The Doctrine of Lapse was introduced by Lord Wellesley. 1
Reason (R): Under the Doctrine of Lapse a state could be annexed if its ruler died without a natural male heir.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

10. **Assertion (A):** Macaulay's Minute of 1835 promoted English education in India. 1
Reason (R): The Minute was written to promote education only in Indian languages.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. How did the Resident control a ruler? 2

12. How did the telegraph and railways help suppress 1857? 2

13. Why did Siraj-ud-daulah lose even with a big army? 2

14. Why was Macaulay's Minute influential? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Source: 'Indian in blood but English in taste.' Identify the author and the aim. 3

16. Case: A peasant is forced to grow indigo and falls into debt. Suggest three reasons for revolt. 3

17. Compare the Sannyasi-Fakir Rebellion with the Santhal Rebellion. 3

OR

Analyse why the Indian resistance of 1857 failed. 3

18. Evaluate Naoroji's drain theory. 3

OR

Evaluate Rani Lakshmibai as a symbol of resistance. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. **Case study.** In 1757 the Nawab of Bengal, Siraj-ud-daulah, was defeated by Robert Clive at Plassey. Mir Jafar, a commander who had conspired with Clive, was made the new Nawab. The British often used rivalries among Indian rulers to expand their power. 5
(i) In which year was the Battle of Plassey fought?
(ii) Who was the Nawab defeated?
(iii) Who became Nawab afterwards?
(iv) Explain the strategy of 'divide and rule' with reference to the passage.

20. Evaluate the claim that the British ruled India by dividing it. 5

OR

Evaluate the role of leaders such as Lakshmibai, Hazrat Mahal and Bahadur Shah Zafar in 1857. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks